

THE PROTECTION CLUSTER INCLUDES SUB-CLUSTERS ON CHILD PROTECTION, GENDER BASED VIOLENCE AND MINE ACTION



PROTECTION CONCERNS

- **Civilian casualties:** The UN Human Rights Monitoring Mission in Ukraine recorded 18 conflict-related casualties (2 persons killed and 16 injured) All 5 civilian casualties recorded in August were caused by mine/ERW related incidents in Luhansk NGCA.
- **Security:** Following the introduction of the ceasefire agreement on 27 July, the number of security incidents decreased. INSO recorded 785 security incidents, which is 40% less than in May-June 2020.
- **COVID-19:** The number of COVID-19 cases significantly increased. Since the start of the pandemic, 2,242 COVID-19 cases have been registered in Donetsk and Luhansk GCA, of these 72% in July-August. Around 50% of all cases are people over 50 years; 3,374 cases were registered by de-facto authorities in NGCA, of these 50% in July-August 2020.
- **Freedom of movement:** In July-August, two out of five EECPs operated in restricted mode with the other three closed. At Stanytsia Luhanska EECP, entering NGCA is only allowed for people with NGCA residence registration. At Novotroitske EECP, entering NGCA is permitted only for people included in lists prepared by NGCA de facto authorities. People continue to stay overnight at checkpoints, waiting to cross the contact line, or because they are unable to confirm their place of residence. Older persons crossing the contact line often lack mobile phones or have low digital literacy, making it difficult for them to use the 'Diy Vdoma' mobile application, which is mandatory to monitor self-isolation.
- **Access to pension payments:** Oschadbank bank cards, which are needed to withdraw pensions and social benefits, will expire on 1 October, while quarantine restrictions have been prolonged until 31 October. This means that pensioners residing in NGCA will be unable to withdraw their pensions as their cards will be blocked after 1 October and they will need to physically present themselves at Oschadbank in GCA to renew the cards.
- **Child protection:** Children in care who have had to return from boarding institutions due to quarantine restrictions, are being temporarily placed by social services in psychosocial rehabilitation centers, as there is nowhere else to house them. This negatively affects their mental health.
- **Access to social benefits:** Following the adoption of the Cabinet of Ministers Resolution №632 on 22 July 2020, unemployed single parents are not entitled to receive child benefits. This particularly impacts IDP and Roma single mothers who are often employed unofficially or are struggling to find employment.

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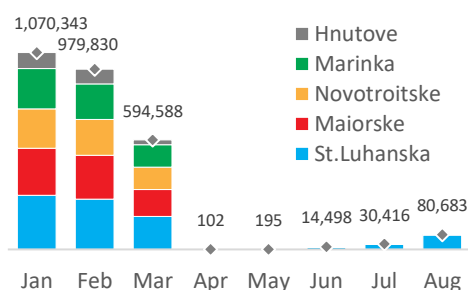
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EECPs crossings in 2020



Source: State Border Guard Service

HIGHLIGHTS

PROTECTION RESPONSE

- UNHCR **provided 30 bicycles to Sverdlovsk (Dovzhansk) Center (Luhansk NGCA)**, which provides home-based care. The bicycles will help social workers deliver food and medicine to 300 older people and people with disabilities.
- On 6 August, NGO Proliska installed **3 free access Wi-Fi points** at the EECF Stanytsia Luhanska to help people crossing the contact line to install the 'Diy Vdoma' application, which is mandatory for monitoring self-isolation.
- The Norwegian Refugee Council provided **legal support, including information, counseling and legal assistance**, to 598 persons; 39% of whom reside in NGCA.
- In July-August, the NGO Right to Protection **provided individual legal assistance to 1,544 persons**, and won 105 court cases, which received decisions in favor of the plaintiff.
- In July, the Ukrainian Red Cross Society **launched a hotline, 'Let's Talk'** for the residents of Donetsk and Luhansk regions, where people can discuss their concerns and receive psychosocial support.
- Polish Humanitarian Action **provided psychosocial support by phone to 947 older people** from 33 isolated settlements. The most vulnerable older people received support with individual home visits.
- SOS Children's Villages **provided individual case management, including psychosocial and financial support**, to 326 vulnerable families with 750 children from Severodonetsk, Starobelsk and Stanytsia Luhanska.
- In July, UNFPA launched a project to **support seven municipal mobile teams in Donetsk and Luhansk regions**, providing specialized medical and psychosocial services. In July-August, these mobile teams examined more than 400 persons living along the conflict line and in isolated settlements.
- The Ukrainian Foundation for Public Health mobile teams **provided psychosocial support and referral services to 640 GBV survivors** and 210 children affected by domestic violence.

ADVOCACY

- On 2 September, the Cabinet of Ministers adopted [Decree №747](#), **providing an administrative mechanism for the compensation of property** destroyed as a result of the conflict. This has long been advocated for by Protection Cluster partners, including UNHCR, OHCHR, IOM, NGO Right to Protection, Danish Refugee Council, Donbas SOS and others, under the leadership of the Norwegian Refugee Council.
- On 14 July 2020, the **Ministry for Reintegration of TOT adopted Decree №52** updating the List of Goods restricted or prohibited for movement through the contact line. The decree provides for an increase of the maximum amount of money allowed to be transferred from GCA to NGCA from 20 000 UAH to 50 000 UAH.

TRAININGS/EVENTS

- CIVIC conducted **two trainings on negotiation skills, communication, and facilitation of dialogue** for 42 representatives of civil-military administrations and people living near the contact line.
- On 18 August, DRC-DDG conducted a training session on how to **obtain official disability status** resulting from mine/ERW-related injuries for 17 persons in Verkhnyonotetske.
- NGO Ukrainian Deminers Association **conducted an EORE session for 55 children and adults** during an online summer camp 'Peaceful Summer for Children'. 29 child participants are IDPs and 12 reside in NGCA.
- FSD conducted an **EORE session for more than 20 children** in the sanatorium Perlyna Donechyny in Sviatohirsk.
- People in Need **conducted trainings on non-violent communication**, fundamentals of interaction with children and introduction to a community-based approach for 114 persons from Donetsk and Luhansk regions.
- Save the Children jointly with NGO Children of Rainbow Centre **conducted open-air activities on Healing and Education through the Arts (HEART) for 45 children** with disabilities in Severodonetsk.

KEY FIGURES ON THE PROTECTION RESPONSE IN JANUARY-JULY 2020



2.8M

People in need

of protection monitoring missions conducted and recorded

29%

Target:
6,400



1.4M

People targeted

of persons receiving information

26%

Target:
1,318,000



0.58M

People reached

of persons receiving Mine Risk Education through MRE awareness sessions

14%

Target:
265,000



41

Partners

women, men, boys and girls with access to essential services

39%

Target:
270,000

of women, men, boys and girls supported through peace-building or social cohesion projects, community-based activities

31%

Target:
70,000